

FROM Robert Samuel White
TO [Volunteer Services Lead]
CC [Park Supervisor]; [Park Manager]
DATE February 12, 2025, 8:22 AM PT
SUBJECT **Re: Jessie M. Honeyman State Park Hosting for March 2025**
DOCUMENT 01JKXC1M80V9A90EV4SX6BFJ35

Dear [Park Manager], [Park Supervisor], and [Volunteer Services Lead]:

I would like to start by saying what an honor it has been to be at Honeyman and to experience this place firsthand, and I deeply respect the energy and commitment it takes to manage a place like this.

I have had a few days to think about what happened. I would like to offer my perspective for your consideration and a possible path forward, if you'll do me the honor of considering it.

First, there was an unfortunate confluence of events. A water outage, an angry guest, a power outage, an angry guest, a new volunteer, the early morning hour, a hesitant text for clarification, and a reply that didn't quite make the volunteer feel he had his bearings here.

Next, the volunteer asserted a boundary as softly as he could and he felt it was respected and was already moving on, but the system saw it differently, and a park manager showed up at the start of his shift, without his direct supervisor for support, and this created a whole new situation.

This volunteer is new to this life, to volunteering at the state parks, and just trying to navigate it with as much care as he can possibly muster. He's not here trying to stand out or create waves of any kind. He just wants to be supported as he learns to integrate into this rhythm.

I have been worried all week. I have not seen [Volunteer Services Lead], and that feels purposeful. Because he could have put my mind at ease instantly. I would like to ask we reset. Please take the time to get to know me. I sincerely believe I can be a valuable resource to you. And I want that so much.

And my time here is so limited. If you don't want me back here next year, I will understand this. I will regret it, because I care about this place and I really thought I was building something meaningful here. But I will understand.

I have volunteer assignments lined up all year as I explore this wonderful coast. I don't want to jeopardize that. I will conform. I will recalibrate. I will be a model volunteer. I hope that you will give me that opportunity.

Sam